Leonard Leye Li

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ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

UNSW Sydney, UNSW Business School
Senior Lecturer 2021–present
Lecturer 2019–2021

University of Washington, Foster School of Business
Visiting Scholar 2025

EDUCATION

UNSW Sydney 2016–2019
Ph.D. in Accounting

Australian National University 2013–2014
Master of Finance (with Distinction)

Shanghai University of Finance and Economics 2008–2012
Bachelor of Economics in Statistics

RESEARCH

Research Interests

Financial accounting; Shareholder litigation; Stock price crash risk; Voluntary disclosure

Featured Publications

1. "Flu fallout: Information production constraints and corporate disclosure" with Chen Chen, Louise Yi Lu and Rencheng Wang. *Journal of Accounting Research* 2023, 64(4): 1063-1108.
   https://doi.org/10.1111/1475-679X.12486
   - Best Paper Award of AFAANZ 2020 Annual Conference.
   - Featured in BusinessThink, Research@SMU e-Newsletter, and Monash Business School IMPACT.
2. "Death is a Law: The effect of CEO death anxiety on management forecasts 'with Yu Flora Kuang, Louise Yi Lu and Bo Qin. *Accounting, Organizations and Society* 2022, 102: 101350.
   https://doi.org/10.1016/j.aos.2022.101350
   - Featured in BusinessThink.
3. "Financial statement comparability and expected crash risk" with Jeong-Bon Kim, Louise Yi Lu and Yangxin Yu. *Journal of Accounting and Economics* 2016, 61(2-3): 294-312.
   https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jacceco.2015.12.003

- Featured in CFA Enterprising Investor.

Other Refereed Journal Articles

4. "The impact of local corruption on firms' narrative R&D disclosures" with Rui Huang, Xuejun Jiang, Louise Yi Lu, and Yangxin Yu. *Journal of Corporate Finance* 2025, 94: 102841.
   https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jcorpfin.2025.102841
   - Featured in BusinessThink.
5. "The opioid crisis, employee health capital, and corporate information production" with Louise Yi Lu, Dongyue Wang and Mark Wilson. *European Accounting Review* 2025, 34(2): 721-749.
   https://doi.org/10.1080/09638180.2023.2272622
6. "Repetitive key audit matters and audit effort" with Wenhui Lin, Lina Zixuan Li, and David Hay. *Pacific Accounting Review*, 2025, 37(2): 209-242.
   https://doi.org/10.1108/PAR-08-2024-0168
7. "Does client importance affect key audit matters reporting? New Zealand evidence" with Ruoyu Ji, Lina Zixuan Li and Gary S. Monroe.*Pacific Accounting Review*, 2024, 6(3-4): 277-296.
   https://doi.org/10.1108/PAR-04-2024-0072
8. "Managerial litigation risk and auditor choice" with Gary S. Monroe and Jeff Coulton. *International Journal of Auditing* 2024, 28(1): 142-169.
   https://doi.org/10.1111/ijau.12322
9. "Workforce diversity and financial statement readability" with Louise Yi Lu, Yi Wang and Yangxin Yu. *Accounting & Finance* 2023, 63(S1): 1599-1631.
   https://dx.doi.org/10.1111/acfi.13056
   - Peter Brownell Manuscript Award of *Accounting & Finance* 2023-24.
10. "Managerial litigation risk and corporate investment efficiency: Evidence from Universal Demand laws" with Gary S. Monroe and Jeff Coulton. *Journal of Empirical Legal Studies* 2023, 20(1): 196-232.
    https://dx.doi.org/10.1111/jels.12340
    - *JELS* top 10 most-cited papers published in 2023.
    - Featured in Faculti.
11. "The moderating effect of board gender diversity on the relation between corporate social responsibility and firm value" with Yunyi Li, Lina Zixuan Li and Charl de Villiers. *Journal of Management Control* 2022, 33(1): 109–143.
    https://doi.org/10.1007/s00187-022-00334-x
    - Featured in Columbia Law School's Blue Sky Blog and University of Auckland News and Opinions.
12. "External labor market competitions and stock price crash risk: Evidence from exposures to competitor CEOs' award-winning events" with Louise Yi Lu and Dongyue Wang. *Accounting & Finance* 2022, 62(S1): 1421-1460.
    https://doi.org/10.1111/acfi.12828
13. "The impact of the Leahy-Smith America Invents Act on firms' R&D disclosure" with Rui Huang, Louise Yi Lu and Hai Wu. *European Accounting Review* 2021, 30(5): 1067-1104.
    https://doi.org/10.1080/09638180.2020.1806896

14. "Financial statement comparability and managers' use of corporate resources" with Jeong-Bon Kim, Louise Yi Lu and Yangxin Yu. *Accounting & Finance* 2021, 61(S1): 1697-1742.
https://doi.org/10.1111/acfi.12642
15. "Social capital and managers' use of corporate resources" with Ziqi Gao and Louise Yi Lu. *Journal of Business Ethics* 2021, 168(3): 593–613.
https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-019-04223-7
16. "State ownership and abnormal accruals in highly-valued firms: Evidence from China" with Gary S. Monroe and Jenny Jing Wang. *Journal of Contemporary Accounting & Economics* 2021, 17(1): 100223.
https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jcae.2020.100223

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Working Papers

1. "Building Better Information: The Role of Indoor Environmental Quality" with Bingxu Fang, Rui Huang, Louise Yi Lu and Rencheng Wang.
https://ssrn.com/abstract=4894690
   - Presented at *Shanghai University of Finance and Economics*, *UNSW Sydney*, *University of Sydney* and *University of Queensland*.
   - R&R at *Review of Accounting Studies*.
2. "Party Politics: Evidence on the Extent and Origin of Partisan Bias in CEOs" with Steven F. Cahan, Lily Chen, and Louise Yi Lu.
   - Presented at *Australian National University*, *Singapore Management University*, *University of Auckland*, *Macquarie University* and *University of Tasmania*.
   - R&R at *European Accounting Review*.
3. "Topical dispersion of risk factor disclosures and stock price crash risk" with Zihang Peng.
https://ssrn.com/abstract=5061977
   - Presented at *Monash University* and *University of Auckland*.
4. "CSR contracting and management earnings guidance" with Bo Qin and Lu Yang.
   - Presented at AFAANZ 2020 Annual Conference.
5. "Spillover effects of bankruptcy on voluntary disclosure" with Ziqi Gao, Louise Yi Lu and Rencheng Wang.
   - Presented at AFAANZ 2021 Annual Conference, and *The University of Newcastle*.
6. "Litigation risk and cost behavior: Evidence from derivative lawsuits" with Gary S. Monroe and Jeff Coulton.
https://ssrn.com/abstract=3020842
   - Presented at AAA MAS 2018 Midyear Meeting, AFAANZ 2018 Annual Conference, and *The University of Melbourne*.

SSRN: https://ssrn.com/author=2462553.

Research Grants

1. UNSW Business School Dean's Research Fellowship (A$10,000), 2023-2024.
2. AFAANZ Research Grant (A$6,231), 2021. "Critical audit matters and debt contract design" with Lina Li and Zihang Peng.
3. AFAANZ Research Grant (A$7,500), 2019. "CSR contracting and management earnings guidance" with Bo Qin and Lu Yang.

Conference Presentations

AFAANZ Annual Conference. Auckland, New Zealand	2024
AFAANZ Annual Conference. Gold Coast, Australia	2023
AFAANZ Annual Conference. Melbourne, Australia	2022
AAA Annual Meeting. San Francisco, California	2019
AFAANZ Annual Conference. Brisbane, Australia	2019
JCAE Mid-Year Conference. Brisbane, Australia	2019
AFAANZ Annual Conference. Auckland, New Zealand	2018
AAA MAS Midyear Meeting. Scottsdale, Arizona	2018

Seminar Presentations

Macquarie University	2025
JASO (online, discussant)	2025
Shanghai University of Finance and Economics	2024
ECRSN (online)	2024
The University of Queensland	2024
The University of Sydney	2023
The University of Auckland	2023
Monash University	2023
ECRSN (online)	2023
Singapore Management University	2022
ECRSN (online)	2021
The University of Newcastle	2021
The University of Auckland (online)	2020
Australian National University (online)	2020
Shanghai Jiao Tong University	2019

TEACHING

Teaching Interest

Financial accounting; Data analytics; Financial analysis

Courses Taught

UNSW Sydney

ACCT3672/5972 Accounting Analytics for Business Decision Making	2024–present
COMM1240 Financial Management	2026
COMM1140 Financial Management	2021–2024
COMM5601 Interdisciplinary Applications of Analytics Techniques	2024
COMM8101 Statistical Methods for Business Research	2023
ACCT1501 Accounting and Financial Management 1A	2019–2021

AFAANZ Doctoral Education Network (AFDEN)

Python Coding for Accounting and Finance Research	2025-present

University of Washington

BUS AN 500 Finance and Accounting	2025 Spring

Courses Co-developed

COMM5601 Interdisciplinary Applications of Analytics Techniques	2024
ZZBU6509 Financial Modelling	2020

HDR Students Supervised

UNSW Sydney

Shelly Xiaotong Deng, Ph.D. Co-Supervisor	2024–present
Mingzhe Wu, Honors Co-Supervisor	2024
Layla Yixuan Li, Honors Co-Supervisor	2023

Australian National University

Kathy Dongyue Wang, Ph.D. External Committee Member	2019–2023
Summer Rui Huang, Ph.D. External Committee Member	2019–2022
Ziqi Gao, Ph.D. External Committee Member	2019–2022

SERVICE

UNSW Sydney

UNSW Co-op program Accounting & Business Management panelist	2025
School Rep. of Adv standing, Cross Institution, Studies Abroad	2023–present
Senior Lecturer Promotion Committee Member	2022

Editorial Services

Deputy Editor of *Accounting & Finance*	2024–present
Editorial Board Member of *Accounting & Finance*	2023–present

Ad-hoc Reviewer

2025: *Journal of Banking and Finance*, *Journal of Accounting, Auditing and Finance*, *Australian Accounting Review*
2025: *Journal of Accounting and Economics*, *Review of Accounting Studies*, *Abacus*
2024: *Journal of Accounting, Auditing, and Finance*, *China Journal of Accounting Research*, *Emerging Markets Review*, *Accounting & Finance*, AFAANZ Annual Conference
2023: *Journal of Empirical Legal Studies*, *Emerging Markets Review*, *International Journal of Auditing*, *Corporate Governance: An International Review*, *Australian Accounting Review*, *Accounting & Finance*, *China Journal of Accounting Research*, *Journal of Contemporary Accounting & Economics*, AFAANZ Annual Conference
2022: *European Accounting Review*, *Corporate Governance: An International Review*, *International Journal of Auditing*, *Accounting & Finance*, *Pacific Accounting Review*, AAA FARS Midyear Meeting, AFAANZ Annual Conference
2021: *Journal of Corporate Finance*, *European Accounting Review*, *Journal of Business Ethics*, *Australian Accounting Review*, *Accounting & Finance*, *Journal of Contemporary Accounting & Economics*, AFAANZ Annual Conference
2020: *Journal of Business Ethics*, *Journal of Contemporary Accounting & Economics*, *Asia-Pacific Journal of Accounting & Economics*, *Accounting & Finance*, *Corporate Governance: An International Review*, AFAANZ Annual Conference
2019: *Corporate Governance: An International Review*, *Accounting & Finance*, AAA Annual Meeting, AFAANZ Annual Conference
2018: *Australian Journal of Management*, *Accounting & Finance*, AFAANZ Annual Conference, AAA MAS Midyear Meeting

HONORS and AWARDS

Peter Brownell Manuscript Award	2024
UNSW Business School Research Excellence Award	2023
UNSW Business School Dean's Research Fellowship	2023
AFAANZ Best Paper Award in Financial Accounting	2020
UNSW Tuition Fee Scholarship	2016
Golden Key International Honor Society Top Student Award	2014
CFA Program Exam Level II	2013
CFA Program Exam Level I	2011

Updated: March, 2026